TaxIQ: Product Requirements Document

The Product Sprints capstone, Product Club, IIT Kanpur. Updated 3 Nov 2026.

At a glance

TaxIQ turns tax planning into a 2-minute, 4-step quiz that tells a salaried Indian which tax regime saves them more and the next three moves to make. It closes the personalisation-speed gap between fast-but-generic calculators and personalised-but-slow filing flows, and is forecast to deliver 150K Season-1 activations and about 2,700 monetised conversions.

Item	Detail
Product	TaxIQ, the Tax Planning module inside the app
Season 1	Dec 2026 to Jul 2027 (FY 2026-27: proof submission, 31 Mar investment deadline, 31 Jul filing)
Primary users	Salaried taxpayers aged 22 to 45 earning Rs 6 to 30 lakh a year
North Star	Personalised tax plans delivered (quiz completed and Old vs New result viewed)
Core differentiator	A personal, actionable answer in under 2 minutes, with no documents
Tax rules in engine	FY 2026-27; Budget 2026 left slabs, standard deduction and rebate unchanged
Prototype	prototype/index.html, engine tested in tests/

1. Problem statement and root cause

Users come to the module with one question, "which regime, and do I need to invest more?", and leave before they get a personal answer. That single gap blocks all four goals of the module.

Brief recap. The app has launched a Tax Planning module with four goals: acquire users interested in tax help, engage them with easy tax education, collect data on income, deductions and investments, and monetise later through health/life insurance, tax-saving products and tax-filing services. As PM, the strategy must cover user acquisition, engagement hooks, low-friction data collection, KPIs, and a prototype of the full flow from entry to recommendations.

Problem hypothesis. Today's options are either fast but generic (calculators, blogs, finfluencer reels) or personalised but slow (filing flows that need Form 16 and AIS). With no quick personal answer there is no trust moment, so users share no data and never see an offer that fits them.

Why now. The choice is both harder and higher-stakes than before:

- The new regime is the default and makes taxable income up to Rs 12 lakh tax-free through the Section 87A rebate; a salaried person pays nothing up to about Rs 12.75 lakh (slabs).
- The old regime still rewards large deductions, so the answer depends on a break-even deduction level that changes with income (break-even analysis).

- About 72% of filers (5.27 crore of 7.28 crore returns for AY 2024-25) already chose the new regime (Business Today). The 28% on the old regime, and the many who never checked, are the people who need an answer.
- The Income-tax Act, 2025 replaced the 1961 Act from 1 Apr 2026 and renumbered sections, so familiar names like "80C" now confuse as much as they help.

Root cause analysis (5 Whys)

1. Why do users leave the module without a plan? They never reach a result that feels like it is about them.
2. Why not? Getting one takes many inputs (salary breakup, HRA, 80C, 80D, home loan) full of jargon.
3. Why so many inputs? Existing tools mirror the ITR form instead of the decision the user is making.
4. Why does that hurt more now? The right regime depends on a break-even deduction level users cannot work out in their head.
5. Why does it matter to the business? Without a fast personal answer there is no trust, so no consented data and no basis for a relevant offer.

Root cause: a personalisation-speed gap. No tool gives a personal, actionable tax answer in under 2 minutes without documents. Closing that gap is TaxIQ's core differentiator.

2. Target audience and personas

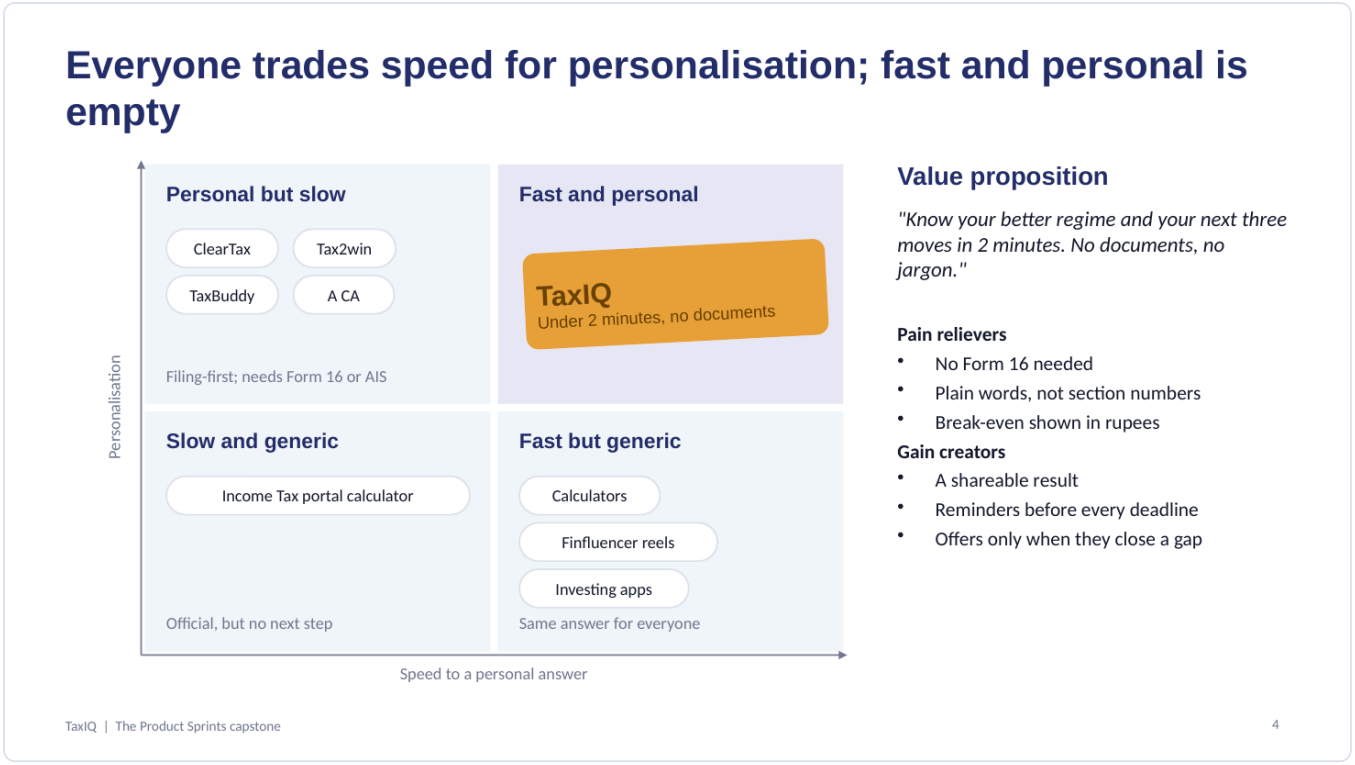
Season 1 targets salaried taxpayers aged 22 to 45 earning Rs 6 to 30 lakh. They face the regime choice every April and the proof deadline every January, and they can be served well without documents. Of the 7.28 crore returns for AY 2024-25, 3.34 crore were ITR-1, the simple salaried return. Freelancers follow in Phase 3.

Persona	Profile	Needs	Behaviour today	Job to be done
Ananya, the first-salary fresher	24, Bengaluru, software engineer, Rs 9 lakh CTC, first job	Which regime to declare to HR; whether she needs to invest at all	Asks colleagues, watches finfluencer reels, keeps the default	When HR asks for my regime declaration, I want a clear answer for my salary, so I can submit without second-guessing.
Rohit, the deduction-heavy planner	34, Pune, product manager, Rs 22 lakh, home loan, pays parents' health cover	Whether the old regime still wins; what to top up before 31 Mar, and where	Spreadsheets and a CA friend; buys ELSS in a March rush	When the March deadline nears, I want to know exactly what to top up, so I don't overpay tax or lock money into the wrong product.
Meera, the freelancer (Phase 3)	29, Jaipur, freelance designer, Rs 14 lakh, presumptive income	Regime choice, advance-tax dates, filing help	Pays a local CA once a year; misses advance-tax dates	When a quarter ends, I want to know what tax I owe, so I avoid interest and filing stress.

Anti-persona. Traders and high earners with capital gains, F&O, crypto or foreign income, and business owners needing audits. They need a CA, not a 2-minute quiz, so TaxIQ flags their complexity and routes them to assisted filing instead of giving an answer it cannot stand behind.

3. Competitive analysis

Every alternative trades speed against personalisation: filing platforms are personal but slow, calculators and content are fast but generic. Nobody gives a personal answer in under 2 minutes, which is the gap TaxIQ is built to own.



Alternative	Strength	Gap for our user	Time to a personal answer (est.)
ClearTax	DIY and expert filing; personalised 80C/80D tips; filing through app or WhatsApp	Planning lives inside the filing flow, which starts from Form 16	10 to 20 min
Tax2win	Low-cost filing, auto regime selection, tax-saving nudges, post-filing notice help	Same form-first flow; planning is basic	10 to 20 min
TaxBuddy	Expert-assisted filing with AI-driven planning advice	Paid and expert-led; not a quick self-serve check	Hours to days
Income Tax portal calculator	Official and free	Form-like inputs; no recommendation or next step	5 to 10 min
Investing apps (ELSS, NPS sections)	One-tap purchase of tax-saving products	Product-first with no regime answer, so they can sell 80C products to new-regime users who gain nothing	Not personal
Finfluencer reels and blogs	Free, relatable, fast	Generic and often out of date	Under 1 min, not personal
TaxIQ	4-step quiz, Old vs New comparator, top 3 moves	Must earn trust as a new entrant	Under 2 min

Times are team estimates, to be verified with timed walkthroughs during discovery.

Value proposition: "Know your better regime and your next three moves in 2 minutes. No documents, no jargon."

- **Pain relievers:** no Form 16 needed; plain-language labels instead of section numbers; the break-even shown in rupees.
- **Gain creators:** a shareable result; reminders before every deadline; offers shown only when they save tax or close a protection gap.

4. Goals and objectives

TaxIQ succeeds in Season 1 if 150K users get a personalised tax plan and about 2,700 of them buy a product that fits it.

North Star metric: personalised tax plans delivered. The count of users who finish the quiz and see their Old vs New result. It measures the user's job (a clear answer) and gates every later business outcome: no plan, no consent, no relevant offer.

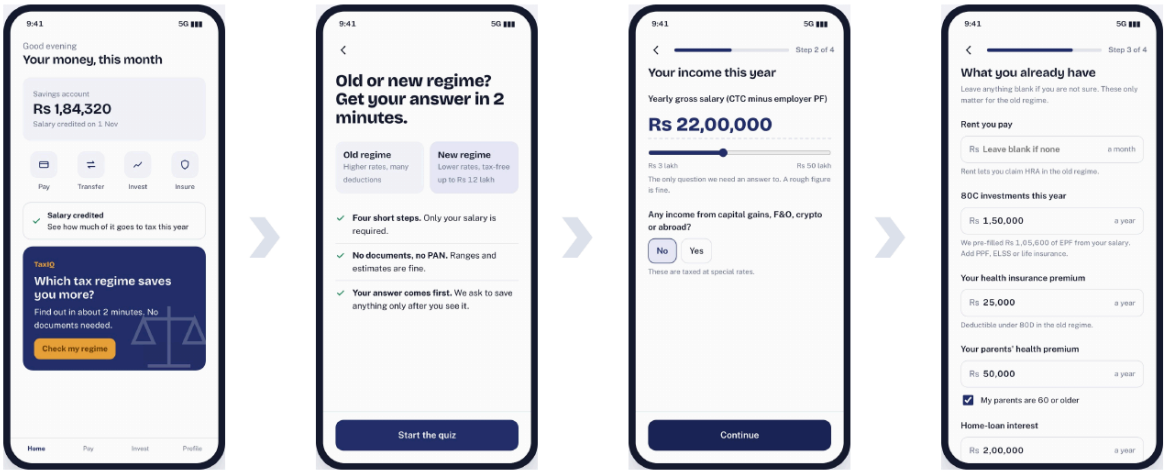
Module goal	AARRR stage	Measurable outcome	Season-1 target
Acquire tax-curious users	Acquisition	Unique users reaching the TaxIQ landing screen	1.5M
Acquire tax-curious users	Activation	Quiz starts, completion rate, median time to result	300K starts; 50% complete = 150K activations; 120 s or less
Collect user data	Activation	Activated users who consent to save their profile and see personalised offers	60% (90K)
Engage with easy content	Retention	Activated users who return within 30 days	30%
Engage with easy content	Referral	Activated users who share their regime card	10%
Monetise via cross-sell	Revenue	Offer click-through, then purchase conversion of offer viewers	12% CTR; 3% conversion = ~2,700

Non-goals for Season 1: full ITR filing inside the module (routed to a partner), advice on individual securities, and capital-gains, F&O or crypto computation.

5. Features and requirements

The MVP is a 4-step quiz that ends in an Old vs New regime comparator and three rupee-valued moves, with consent asked only after the user has their answer.

Prototype: from the home screen to the answer in four short steps



Entry: home banner and salary-day nudge

Landing: one question, no documents

Step 2: salary is the only required input

Step 3: EPF pre-filled; blanks allowed

Flow: entry point (home banner, salary-day nudge, deadline push, SEO page or share link) → landing → 4-step quiz → result (Old vs New tax and saving, break-even in rupees, top 3 moves) → consent to save? → **yes:** saved profile with deadline reminders and personalised offers; **no:** session-only plan with share card and explainers, asked again next visit.

The 4-step quiz

Step	We ask	Why it matters	Smart default
1. About you	Salaried or self-employed; age band	Removes the standard deduction for the self-employed; sets senior-citizen limits	Salaried, under 60
2. Income	Annual gross salary on a slider; any capital gains, F&O, crypto or foreign income	Core tax computation; complex income triggers routing to assisted filing	Slider starts at Rs 10 lakh
3. What you already have	Rent paid (and metro or not); 80C so far; health cover for self and parents; home-loan interest; own NPS	Old-regime deductions; the gaps reveal tax and protection needs	EPF estimated at 12% of basic, with basic assumed at 40% of gross
4. What matters to you	Save tax, grow wealth, protect family, or file stress-free; how you file today	Ranks the top 3 moves and, later, the offers	None

Worked example, Rohit (Rs 22 lakh salary). He claims Rs 4.75 lakh beyond the standard deduction: 80C Rs 1.5 lakh, home-loan interest Rs 2 lakh, health cover Rs 75,000 (self plus senior parents) and NPS Rs 50,000. The comparator shows:

	Old regime	New regime
Taxable income	Rs 16,75,000	Rs 21,25,000
Tax with 4% cess	Rs 3,27,600	Rs 2,40,500

The new regime saves him Rs 87,100. The old regime would need about Rs 7.55 lakh of deductions beyond the standard deduction to break even. His top 3 moves: (1) declare the new regime to HR, saving Rs 87,100; (2) ask HR to route part of his CTC to employer NPS, which still counts in the new regime up to 14% of basic, worth about Rs 32,030 more; (3) keep his parents' health cover for protection, even though it no longer saves tax.

Requirements (MoSCoW for Season 1)

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
F1	4-step quiz	Must	12 inputs or fewer; only salary mandatory; progress bar; blank allowed on every optional field; median completion 120 s or less with 8 test users
F2	Tax engine for FY 2026-27	Must	Both regimes: slabs, standard deduction (Rs 75,000 new, Rs 50,000 old), 87A rebate with marginal relief, surcharge, 4% cess, senior-citizen limits; rules stored as config per tax year; 100% match on 50 CA-verified test profiles
F3	Old vs New comparator	Must	Tax under each regime, savings, recommended regime, break-even deduction in rupees, one-line reason
F4	Top 3 moves	Must	Each move shows rupee impact, why it fits, and whether it works in the user's regime; labelled educational; no product named before consent
F5	Consent and profile save	Must	DPDP-compliant notice; separate opt-ins for saving, reminders and offers; delete in one tap
F6	Deadline reminders	Must	Proof submission (Jan), 31 Mar investment deadline, advance-tax dates (15 Jun, Sep, Dec, Mar), 31 Jul filing; opt-in; 2 pushes a week at most
F7	Personalised offers	Must	Consenting users only; one offer per screen at most; tied to a gap found in F4 (health cover, term cover, NPS, filing service); labelled as a partner offer
F8	Funnel analytics	Must	Events on every step, skipped field, result view, offer view, click and purchase
F9	Shareable regime card	Should	Shows recommended regime and savings band, never income; deep link back to the quiz
F10	60-second explainers	Should	120 words or fewer, linked from the result; CA-reviewed after every Budget
F11	Hindi and two regional languages	Should	Full quiz and result translated; language taken from app setting
F12	Complexity router	Should	Capital gains, F&O, crypto or foreign income route to assisted filing
F13	Tax-saving tracker	Could	Progress toward each deduction limit, updated as the user logs investments
F14	Pre-fill from bank data (Account Aggregator)	Could	With consent, salary and premiums pre-filled; user confirms every value

ID	Requirement	Priority	Acceptance criteria
F15	Form 16 or AIS upload	Could	Parsed fields shown for confirmation before use
F16	Ask-a-CA chat	Could	Partner-led; reply within 24 h
W1	Full ITR filing inside TaxIQ	Won't	Routed to a partner filing service
W2	Capital-gains, F&O and crypto computation	Won't	Covered by F12 routing

Engagement hooks (Hook model)

- **Trigger:** salary-day nudge, deadline reminders, a Budget-day "what changed for you" push.
- **Action:** one tap reopens the saved plan.
- **Variable reward:** "you can still save Rs X", a newly unlocked move, progress toward a deduction limit.
- **Investment:** each extra detail sharpens the plan and raises its confidence badge.
- **Content:** a personal tax calendar, 60-second explainers, and a monthly "tax pulse".

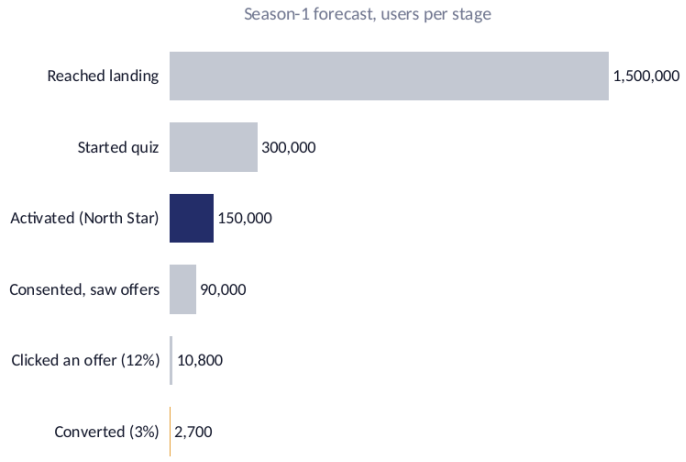
Data collection without friction

- Give before you get: the result comes before any sign-up or consent.
- Ranges and smart defaults instead of exact figures; blanks are always allowed.
- No PAN, Form 16 or documents in Season 1.
- A "why we ask" line on every field; consent per purpose; delete anytime.
- Progressive profiling: one more question per return visit, and only when it changes the answer.

6. Success metrics and impact forecast

The forecast runs 1.5M landing visitors to 150K activations and, through a 12% offer click-through and 3% purchase conversion, to about 2,700 monetised conversions.

Forecast: 150K activations, then a 12% to 3% cross-sell funnel to ~2,700 conversions



North Star	Personalised plans delivered: quiz done and result seen
Activation	50% quiz completion; median result in 120 s or less
Data	60% consent after the answer
Retention	30% return within 30 days; 10% share their card

~Rs 27 lakh in Season 1
at an assumed Rs 1,000 per conversion

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Stage	Users	Rate from previous stage
Reached landing	1,500,000	
Started quiz	300,000	20%
Activated (quiz done, result seen)	150,000	50%
Consented, saw offers	90,000	60%
Clicked an offer	10,800	12%
Converted	2,700	25% of clicks, 3% of offer viewers

The 12% to 3% cross-sell funnel applies only to the 60% of activated users who consent. At an assumed blended Rs 1,000 per conversion (filing fees, insurance commission, NPS), Season 1 earns about Rs 27 lakh at near-zero acquisition cost, because most traffic is in-app. Sensitivity: an 8% click-through cuts conversions to 1,800; 50% consent cuts them to 2,250.

Stage	KPI	Definition	Guardrail
Acquisition	Landing reach; entry click-through by channel	Unique landing visitors; landing visits divided by users shown an entry point	Push opt-out under 1% per campaign
Activation	Quiz completion; median time to result; North Star	Completions divided by starts; seconds from step 1 to result	No single quiz step loses more than 20%
Data	Consent rate; profile depth	Consenting users divided by activated; fields filled per saved profile	Consent withdrawals under 5%
Retention	30-day return; reminder open rate	Activated users with a return visit within 30 days	Uninstalls traced to TaxIQ pushes

Stage	KPI	Definition	Guardrail
Referral	Share rate; K-factor	Shares divided by activated; new activations from shared links divided by activated	None
Revenue	Offer click-through; conversion; revenue per activated user	Clicks divided by offer viewers; purchases divided by offer viewers	"Not relevant" taps under 2%; 30-day policy cancellations
Quality	Tax-engine error reports	Reports of a wrong figure per 10K results	Under 1 per 10K

7. Prioritisation and plan

RICE ranks the quiz and comparator first (score 180), and the roadmap ships in three gated phases that climb the AARRR funnel from activation to revenue.

Feature	Reach (K users per season)	Impact (0.25 to 3)	Confidence	Effort (person-weeks)	RICE score
4-step quiz and Old vs New comparator	300	3	80%	4	180
Deadline reminders	90	2	80%	1	144
60-second explainers	600	0.5	80%	2	120
Top 3 moves	150	3	70%	3	105
Shareable regime card	150	1	50%	1	75
Personalised offers	90	2	70%	3	42
Bank-data pre-fill (Account Aggregator)	100	2	50%	6	16.7
Tax-saving tracker	60	1	60%	3	12
Form 16 or AIS upload	40	2	50%	8	5
Ask-a-CA chat	15	2	50%	6	2.5

RICE = Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort. RICE sets the order; MoSCoW (section 5) sets the scope. Personalised offers score only 42 but are a Must, because monetisation is a module goal; they ship last because they need consented data and partner contracts first.

RICE sets the order, MoSCoW the scope: three gated phases climb the AARRR funnel

Feature	Reach (K)	Impact	Conf.	Effort (pw)	RICE
Quiz + comparator	300	3	80%	4	**180**
Deadline reminders	90	2	80%	1	**144**
60-second explainers	600	0.5	80%	2	**120**
Top 3 moves	150	3	70%	3	**105**
Share card	150	1	50%	1	**75**
Personalised offers	90	2	70%	3	**42**
Bank-data pre-fill	100	2	50%	6	**16.7**

Offers score 42 but are a Must: monetisation is a module goal. They ship last because they need consented data and partner contracts.

Phase 1: Activate

Dec 2026 to Jan 2027 | Acquisition + Activation

Engine, quiz, comparator, top 3 moves, explainers, analytics, SEO pages

◆ Gate 1: 50%+ completion, result in 120 s, engine passes all tests

Phase 2: Engage

Feb to Mar 2027 | Retention + Referral

Consent and saved profile, reminders, share card, languages, complexity router

◆ Gate 2: 50%+ consent, 25%+ return within 30 days

Phase 3: Monetise

Apr to Jul 2027 | Revenue

Personalised offers, filing-service handoff, tracker, pre-fill pilot

Phase	Dates	AARRR stages	Ships	Gate to the next phase
1. Activate	Dec 2026 to Jan 2027	Acquisition, Activation	Tax engine, quiz, comparator, top 3 moves, explainers, analytics, landing and SEO pages	50%+ quiz completion; median result in 120 s or less; engine passes all test profiles
2. Engage	Feb to Mar 2027	Retention, Referral	Consent and saved profile, reminders, share card, languages, complexity router	50%+ consent; 25%+ return within 30 days
3. Monetise	Apr to Jul 2027	Revenue	Personalised offers, filing-service handoff, tax-saving tracker, bank-data pre-fill pilot	Season review

Each gate is a go/no-go: if Gate 1 misses, Phase 2 is spent fixing the quiz instead of adding reminders.

How users find TaxIQ (acquisition, from Phase 1)

- **In-app (product-led):** home banner in proof season (Jan) and declaration season (Apr); a salary-day nudge; entry points inside investing and insurance flows.
- **Content-led SEO:** "old vs new regime calculator FY 2026-27" pages that open straight into the quiz.
- **Creators and communities:** two or three finfluencer collaborations built around the comparator; college and alumni groups for first-jobbers.
- **Product-led loop:** the share card brings friends into the quiz.
- **B2B2C pilot:** HR partners link TaxIQ in their regime-declaration emails.

8. Constraints, assumptions and risks

The biggest constraints are regulatory (what counts as advice, who may sell insurance, how consent works) and a hard calendar: Phase 1 must be live before January proof season.

Constraints

Type	Constraint	Implication for TaxIQ
Regulatory	Personalised investment advice needs SEBI investment-adviser registration; insurance can only be sold through an IRDAI-registered intermediary	Moves are framed as tax education and product categories; offers come from licensed partners and are labelled as such
Privacy	Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023	Purpose-specific consent, data minimisation, one-tap deletion; no PAN or documents in Season 1
Tax law	Income-tax Act, 2025 in force from 1 Apr 2026 with renumbered sections; Budget 2027 may change slabs	Rules held as versioned config per tax year; plain-language labels with old section names as aliases
Time	Phase 1 has about 6 weeks before January proof season	Strict MVP scope (F1 to F8); everything else waits for Phase 2 or 3
Team and budget	1 PM, 1 designer, 3 engineers, 1 analyst, a part-time CA; no paid acquisition in Season 1	Reuse the app's existing notifications, analytics and consent stack; growth through in-app, SEO and creators
Tech	No Form 16 parsing or Account Aggregator link at launch	Self-reported inputs with smart defaults; pre-fill piloted in Phase 3

Assumptions to validate

- The host app reaches enough salaried users for 1.5M of them to see TaxIQ in Season 1 (roughly 5M monthly active users, 30% exposed).
- 20% of landing visitors start the quiz and 50% of starters finish; to be checked with an A/B test of the landing copy.
- 60% of activated users consent once they have seen a useful answer.
- Offer click-through of 12% and 25% purchase among clickers, based on intent created by a personal gap; to be checked in Phase 3.
- Blended revenue of Rs 1,000 per conversion across filing fees, insurance commission and NPS.

Risks and mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Wrong tax figure damages trust	Medium	50-profile CA-verified test suite, release review by a CA, "report a wrong number" link, clear disclaimer
Users see offers as pushy	Medium	One offer per screen, only tied to a gap the user saw, "not relevant" button that tunes later offers
Most users are already on the new regime, so few deduction products fit	High	Shift moves to protection (health, term), employer NPS and the filing service, which suit both regimes

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Seasonality: traffic collapses outside Jan to Mar and Jul	High	Advance-tax and Budget-day hooks, monthly tax pulse, saved profile that wakes up each season
Low consent rate starves monetisation	Medium	Ask only after the result; show what the user gets for each permission; Gate 2 blocks Phase 3 until consent hits 50%

Sources

- Income tax slabs for FY 2025-26 and FY 2026-27, Indian Pay Calculator
- New vs old regime break-even, FY 2026-27, BasuNivesh
- 7.28 crore ITRs filed for AY 2024-25, 5.27 crore under the new regime, Business Today
- Best ITR filing platforms in India, ClearTax
- ClearTax vs Tax2win comparison, ClearTax
- TaxBuddy vs ClearTax vs Tax2Win, TaxBuddy

Competitor pages are partly written by the competitors themselves; treat feature claims as indicative. Funnel rates, team size and revenue per conversion are planning assumptions, not sourced figures.